thamesview

Your magazine from Gallions | gallionsha.co.uk | April 2009



Anti-social behaviour special

All you need to know about reporting it

Meet a resident inspector

Get the inside story on resident involvement

Rewards up for grabs

Recycle your unwanted electrical items for cash

Employment and training open day

How to get on in the downturn

What a catch!

Free fishing activities for all the family

Thamesview April 2009

Kidsview

Gallions Housing Association

Inside: Help with money worries, changes at Tavy Bridge and a Neighbourhood Warden updat

tw magazine

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Spring is here at last!

As the weather finally starts to warm up the Thamesview team is looking forward to getting out and about this spring. There are lots of things to do listed in our events calendar including details of our *Employment and Training Open Day* on the 19th of May and our great *free fishing club* that will be back next month. Why not come along?

In this issue we tell you about some *improvements in our neighbourhoods*, including the installation of high-tech new lights in four of our tower blocks. We need your feedback so that we can make changes to our service and in the community – make sure you get in touch if you have a comment or concern to share.

There are two great articles about recycling in this edition. If you want to help the environment you can get *free advice and access to recycling facilities* from the London Borough of Bexley or send off your unwanted mobile phones, digital cameras or MP3 players and get cash-back from the Simply Drop scheme.

We have a *fantastic anti-social behaviour special* in the Gallions and You section, which contains lots of information about reporting anti-social behaviour and what we will do to help you. Let us know if there are any issues in your street or block.

We really want to know what you think of Thamesview so we have enclosed a reader questionnaire for you to fill in. Your ideas and comments will help us make the magazine even better. Please take 5 minutes to complete our survey – you could even win a £25 voucher if you return it to us by 30th April 2009.

Gallions Housing Association

FSC Mixed Sources

GRB GALLIONS RESIDENTS' BOARD APPROVED

Meet a Resident Inspector!

The Thamesview Team recently caught up with Carol Downes who volunteered to become a Resident Inspector after she had problems with the new kitchen that was fitted in her home. By taking part in the scheme Carol hopes to help improve standards and prevent the same thing happening to another resident.

Thamesview Team (TT):
How are you finding the Resident Inspector Scheme so far?

Carol Downes (CD):
I really enjoyed the initial training session as it gave me an insight into what is involved for me as a Resident Inspector and Gallions as an organisation. There are lots of positive benefits to the scheme. I picked up some brilliant tips on plumbing and conserving heating too!

TT: *What do you like about the Resident Inspector Scheme?*

CD: The other Resident Inspectors are local people who are motivated and committed to making Thamesmead a more comfortable and safer area to live and work. We all have an opportunity to put our views forward and act on what matters to us as residents.

TT: *Is there anything you dislike about the Resident Inspector Scheme?*

CD: Not so far, I feel the scheme is workable if we all have a positive and realistic attitude and work together as a team, sharing knowledge and ideas.

TT: *What do you hope to learn or achieve from taking part?*

CD: This is a new venture for me and I will use this chance to give my input for the benefit of others and myself. I want to keep an open mind and learn as much as I can as I go along.

If you would like to become a Resident Inspector or want to get involved with Gallions please contact us on 0800 83 84 81. We have thirteen great resident participation opportunities so that you can have your say about your neighbourhood and our services.

Lighting up lives

We have recently installed fantastic new lighting in four of our tower blocks because of feedback from our residents and the local police. The improved lighting facilities have been fitted at Hibernia Point, Clewer House, Maplin House and Duxford House off Wolvercote Road.

The lights are state of the art and we are one of the first housing associations in the country to introduce this type of lighting system. The key improvements are:

- ★ 'White' high intensity lighting has been added to the exterior of each block. The bright lights illuminate external walls and walkways to help deter anti-social behaviour.
- ★ Low level lighting has been fitted in internal stairwells and communal areas. The lights automatically increase in intensity and brightness as a resident walks past to improve visibility and safety. This system is also cost effective and environmentally efficient.
- ★ Landing lighting has been added with automatic turn off adjusted to change at British Summer Time.



- ★ Emergency lighting has been also been improved to protect residents' safety at all times.

So far we have received some very positive comments about the changes, with residents telling us that they feel safer and the emergency services advising that the lighting helps them to deliver their services more speedily and effectively. If you would like to find out more about our lighting strategy please contact Anita Dagger on 0800 83 84 81.

Thank you for the feedback



Our Neighbourhood Wardens work to improve things in our community. Their service is focused on what our residents want and we rely on your feedback to help us improve what we do and react to the needs of the community.

We have recently received some fantastic feedback from residents that has made it possible for the Wardens to resolve issues in our neighbourhoods really quickly. Some of the changes that have taken place are:

- The Wardens have increased their presence in our community, carrying out more evening patrols and providing greater reassurance to our elderly and vulnerable residents
- The Wardens have undertaken surveillance activities and gathered evidence in response to reports of sub-letting. We have now been able to take action against the tenants who have breached their tenancy agreements
- Information about anti-social street drinkers has led to the Wardens working with the London Borough of Greenwich to introduce Alcohol Control Zones in problem areas
- The Wardens have acted on reports of anti-social use of motorcycles by working with the police and Tilfen Land to identify those responsible for riding illegally and to confiscate bikes
- Regular lighting inspections have been introduced to improve existing lights, recommend areas that need new lighting and identify lighting vandalism hot-spots
- The Wardens can now issue warnings and Fixed Penalty Notices to residents who dump rubbish in the Greenwich area of Thamesmead. We hope to develop a similar approach with the London Borough of Bexley.
- The Wardens continue to work with young people in schools and in our community to discourage anti-social behaviour and provide information about other local agencies.

We really value feedback from our residents and with your help we can continue to make improvements in our community. If you have any concerns or information to share with us please call the Neighbourhood Wardens on 0800 83 84 81.

Changes at Tavy Bridge

The demolition works at Tavy Bridge are well underway in preparation for phase two of the regeneration project. As part of the project we had to close the Tavy Bridge play area, which restricted pedestrian access between Tavy Bridge and Hartslock Drive. Some pedestrians have used the footbridge over the lake as an alternative route.

The footbridge is narrow and can be very slippery in wet weather conditions so we have temporarily closed the footbridge as a health and safety measure.

Our residents at Tavy Bridge have told us that they have noticed increased noise levels and some vibration because of the demolition in the area. This is due to the large machinery needed to break down the thick concrete of the buildings being removed. This is only a temporary issue and we are working to complete the demolition as quickly as possible.

If you have any queries or concerns about the demolition works call in and see the team at the Tavy Bridge Project Office, 6-8 Tavy Bridge, Tuesday to Thursday between 9:30am and 4:30pm or call Linda Harris on 0800 83 84 81.

Big plans for our play spaces

We are currently working with the London Borough of Bexley to secure funding for improvements to our public play areas for children and young people.

The funding is available from the Department of Children, Schools and Families and we should find out soon if our application is successful.

At the moment we are looking at potential sites where we can develop and improve children's play facilities. We will soon be consulting with local residents, schools and community groups to find out what they would like to see in the area and we need you to get involved.

If you would like to find out more please contact Susan Asquith on 0800 83 84 81 or email sasquith@gallionsha.co.uk



Team Gallions Interest Group – latest successes

Team Gallions Interest Group is one of our most long running resident participation groups.

The team includes a representative from Team Gallions (our Environmental Services division) and local residents who are interested in improving the cleanliness and environmental quality in our neighbourhoods.

They meet bi-monthly and have really made a difference in the community. Here are some of their most recent achievements:

- After the successful removal of moss at Teeswater Court we are spraying the other courts in the area
- We are running a trial of pigeon deterrents in some of our tower blocks.
- Dog bins across our neighbourhoods have been replaced and fixed

If you would like to help improve your street and want to get involved with the Team Gallions Interest Group contact us on 0800 83 84 81.

Protect your belongings

Gallions looks after the building that you live in but we are not responsible for replacing your furniture or personal items if they are stolen or accidently damaged.

You should take out contents insurance to make sure that you are protected if your belongings are damaged or you are burgled. Contents insurance will also often cover you if an accident in your home damages a neighbour's items.

We can help you access contents insurance and are working with the National Housing Federation in conjunction with Jardine Lloyd Thompson Tenants Risk to offer residents a simple and affordable home contents policy. Contact us on 0800 83 84 81 to find out more. You can also get insurance from a number of independent companies – websites like www.moneysupermarket.com have details of the types of insurance cover available.



Get rewarded for recycling



The London Borough of Bexley has joined forces with Royal Mail to launch an exciting new initiative which gives residents the chance to earn some cash-back, help the environment and support a good cause - all at the same time!

'Simply Drop' is a new service from Royal Mail which makes it easy for residents of the borough to earn money for themselves or a charity when recycling their unwanted electronic items.

The scheme has been launched as a pilot in Bexley, where residents have been sent degradable freepost plastic envelopes to send mobile phones, digital cameras and MP3 players for recycling. Phones and certain other items recycled in this way will be worth at least £5 and, in some cases, a great deal more.

Ten per cent of all profits will go to the children's charity Barnardo's. Users can also choose to donate their payment to a charity of their choice, one of which is the Mayor of Bexley's Charity Appeal, Alzheimer's Disease Society Bexley Branch.

Many of the items received will be refurbished or their electronics reused. Materials such as copper or lead will be extracted and reused, which will help reduce the use of natural resources and cut the amount of energy used in the manufacturing process. Any materials that cannot be reused will be safely disposed of, ensuring nothing harmful ends up in the environment.

Find out more about the scheme, order an envelope and discover how much your items are worth at www.simplydrop.co.uk. The pilot will end on 30th April 2009.

You can also contact Pauline Rootsey at the London Borough of Bexley on 020 8294 6223.

Help with money worries

We want to help if you are struggling to pay your rent and bills so we have a free and confidential benefits health check service available for our residents.

Everyday we help residents like you find out what financial support they are entitled to and can even help fill in the forms. Whatever your circumstances we will give you advice and support.

You should make an appointment for a benefits health check if you are:

- In rent arrears
- Unemployed (even for a short time)
- A lone parent
- On a low income
- Struggling with bills
- Suffering from ill health
- Caring for someone who is ill or disabled
- Interested in applying for working tax credits or pension tax credits
- Currently claiming benefits but your circumstances have changed



Make an appointment today!

Contact us today on 0800 83 84 81 to a make an appointment with our experienced Welfare Benefits Officer. Your home could be at risk if you do not keep up with rent payments.

Thamesmead's One Stop Shop

If you need advice, information or support there is lots on offer at Trust Thamesmead! The One Stop Shop at Trust Thamesmead's office in the town centre has been set up to help residents access free guidance close to home.

Trust Thamesmead provides free professional help to Thamesmead's residents, schools, community groups and traders as well as working with other organisations to offer a great range of services, including:

Tuesday mornings	**Help the Aged**
Tuesday mornings	**Advocacy for Older People in Greenwich**
Tuesday afternoons (monthly)	**Shaw Trust**
Tuesday afternoons (monthly)	**HER Centre**
Wednesday mornings	**First Step Trust**
Wednesdays all day	**Resources Plus**
Thursday mornings	**Thamesmead Law Centre**
Thursdays all day	**Next Steps**
Fridays all day	**GLLaB (Greenwich Local Labour and Business)**
Friday mornings	**Family Information Services**

Some sessions should be booked in advance so please contact Trust Thamesmead on 0208 320 4470, visit www.trust-thamesmead.co.uk or pop in at 19a Joyce Dawson Way to make an appointment and find out more.

TRUST. THAMESMEAD

Consultation on Stroke and Major Trauma services

Every year, thousands of Londoners have a stroke or suffer a major trauma injury. These patients need direct access to the highest quality specialist care to give them the best chance of survival and reduce disability.

Currently, the standard of care varies considerably across London, and more people in London are dying from stroke and major trauma than in many other parts of the UK and the world.

Healthcare for London, an ambitious 10 year plan to transform health and healthcare in the capital, has developed plans to introduce world-class specialist stroke and major trauma services which would ensure all Londoners are within 30 to 45 minutes ambulance journey of a stroke or major trauma centre.

Consultation on these proposals is underway and Healthcare for London wants your views. You can have your say at a health fair near you, online at www.healthcareforlondon.nhs.uk or by calling 0808 238 5481.

The consultation will end on 8th May 2009, with full details and supporting documents on the Health Care for London website.

SPOTLIGHT ON

Greenmead Children's Centre

Greenmead Children's Centre, near Bexley Business Academy, has a great range of services for parents and carers of children from 0 to 5 years old. The exciting regular activities include Baby Group, Stay and Play, Tots to Toddlers and Ready Steady Go! (2 years plus). There are often special events too – this month they will be offering the brilliant bookable activity 'We're going on a Bear Hunt'.

Greenmead Children's Centre is hoping to increase the range of activities on offer especially for dads. If you are a dad and have an idea or suggestion for fun activities for you and your little ones please contact the centre.

Greenmead Children's Centre regularly publishes a full programme of activities, please visit the team at Lime Row, Erith, DA18 4HW or call 020 8320 1618 to find out more.

For little ones (under 5)

Greenmead Children's Centre, Lime Row (off Yarnton Way), telephone 020 8320 1618

Goose-e-ganders parent and toddler group, Broadwater Village Hall, telephone 07958 640645

Toddles, Manor Close Community Hall, Manor Close. Term time, Monday to Friday 9.30am until 11.30am and 12.30pm until 2.30pm.

Toddles with Tavy Bridge Pre-School, Senior Citizens Hall, Tavy Bridge, telephone 07950 853481

Lighthouse Parent and Toddler Group, Emmanuel Church Hall, telephone 0208 312 4700, Wednesdays and Fridays 1.30pm until 3pm.

Young Foundations Pre-School, Emmanuel Church Hall, telephone 0208 312 4700, Monday until Friday 9.30am until 12 noon.

Toy Library, Linton Mead Primary School, Central Way, telephone 0208 310 1902, Friday 9am until 11am, term time only, for under 5s.

Discovery Children's Centre, Battery Road, telephone 0208 855 4320, Monday, Wednesday and Thursday 9am until 4pm and Tuesday and Friday 9am until 1.30pm.

For bigger ones

The cAve climbing wall, Arch 3, Harrow Manor Way, telephone 0208 320 4494, www.trust-thamesmeadcave.co.uk, Monday to Friday 4pm until 7pm and weekends 1.30pm until 5.30pm, for under 18s.

Fun Club, Glimpsing Green, telephone 0208 311 6777, Saturday mornings, for under 11s with a disability.

JMF Support Group, Jubilee Hall, Lytton Strachey Path, telephone 0208 310 5885, Saturday 1pm until 3pm

Rainbows, Church of the Cross, Lensbury Way, telephone 0208 310 2419, for 5 to 7 year olds.

Rainbows, Abbey Wood Community Centre, 4 Knee Hill, telephone 0208 311 2239, Wednesday 4.45pm until 6pm, for 5 to 7 year olds

Brownies and Guides, Church of the Cross, Lensbury Way, telephone 0208 310 2419, for girls aged 7+.

Brownies, Greenmead Community Centre, telephone 07960 815229, Every Tuesday from 6pm, Girls age 7 to 10.

New Acres Library, Tavy Bridge, telephone 0208 311 5291, for all young people, from babies to teenagers.

Hawksmoor Youth Club, Bentham Road, telephone 0208 312 4022

Heronsgate Youth Club, Whinchat Road, 07950 612826

Performing Arts

Dynamix, Bexley Business Academy, Yarnton Way, telephone 07796 450093, for ages 6 to 20

Theatre Street, Broadwater Village Hall, Gooseander Way, telephone 01322 441977, www.theatrestreet.com, tots to adults

Youth Advisory Project, 12 Tavy Bridge, telephone 0208 311 5111, for 16 to 24 year olds

Threshold Dance and Drama, Jubilee Community Centre, Lytton Strachey Path off Titmuss Avenue, telephone 07949 601935, www.thresholddanceanddrama.co.uk, different times for ages 5 to 16.

Young at Heart

Monday Club Bingo, Jubilee Community Centre, Lytton Strachey Path off Titmuss Avenue, telephone 0208 311 5707, Monday 2pm until 4pm

Over 50s Bingo Club, Greenmead Community Hall, Lime Row, telephone 0208 310 0240, Monday and Thursday 7pm until 9pm

Rendezvous Club, Evenlode House, Coralline Walk, telephone 0208 310 7437, Wednesday, for the over 55s

The Atrium Community Centre, Teeswater Court, telephone 0800 83 84 81, 7 days a week. Fun and free over 50s keep fit classes run Wednesday 4.30pm until 5.30pm.

Editor's note: Thamesview does not endorse or recommend any clubs or groups listed. We aim to provide accurate and up to date information but cannot be held responsible for any misleading or inaccurate information supplied to us.

Events Calendar



There are exciting things happening in your area.

April 2009

Easter holidays 6 - 17 April

For both Greenwich and Bexley schools.

Passover (Jewish) 9 April

The Jewish festival of Passover commemorates the Exodus, the liberation of the Israelites from Egyptian slavery.

Vaisakhi (Sikh) 13 April

Vaisakhi is the Sikh New Year festival and it also commemorates 1699, the year Sikhism was born as a collective faith.

Crossness Beam Engine House 26 April

Take a peak at the Crossness Beam Engine House, Belvedere Road, Abbey Wood and find out more about this historic Grade 1 Listed industrial building right on our doorstep. This event will focus on the engineering aspects of the giant rotation beam engines that powered the pumps. Admission is £5 with children under 16 free.

Need more details? Call 020 8311 3711 or visit www.crossness.org.uk for further information.

May 2009

Half term holiday 25 - 29 May

For both Greenwich and Bexley schools.

Employment and training open day 19 May

Gallions will be running an employment and training open day at Thamesmere Leisure Centre Hall 2pm until 5pm, to help you access local employment and training opportunities. Greenwich Local Labour and Business, Bexley Resources Plus, Building Futures, Bexley College and Greenwich Community College along with Hays Recruitment have been invited to give you advice and information.

Need more details? Email mdunster@gallionsha.co.uk or call Marie Dunster on 0208 320 3679 to register your interest for the event.

If you would like to register for vacancies with Hays Recruitment you will need to bring a passport or driving licence with you.

June 2009

The Story of London throughout June

Join in with the month-long festival celebrating London's past, present and future - from art and architecture to heritage, design, fashion, film, music, theatre, food and more. There will be a range of events taking place across the capital for Londoners and visitors alike.

Need more details? Visit www.london.gov.uk/storyoflondon or call 020 7983 4000 to find out more.

Italian Food Market 6-7 June

Visit Cutty Sark Gardens in Greenwich this weekend and enjoy a taste of the continent. At the Italian Food Market you will have the chance to taste and buy delicious ciabattas, pastries, olives, parma ham and much more. Belissimo!

Need more details? Visit www.greenwich.gov.uk or call 020 8921 4464 for more information. Entry is free.

Fathers Day 21 June

Don't forget to treat your dad!

Just for Fun!



Take some time out to enjoy our brainteasers. Remember you only have to complete the wordsearch for the chance to win a prize.

1 80's anagram

Can you unscramble these words to work out the names of four 1980s music acts?

a. Earn turn it _____

b. Blue curl cut _____

c. Chicken also jam _____

d. Gentle bash _____

2 The big UK quiz

It's St Georges day in April so this quiz is all about the UK.

a. Which is the tallest mountain in the UK?

_____

b. When was the BBC launched?

_____

c. Name the last 4 British Prime Ministers.

_____

d. What is the national flower of England?

_____

Answers:
1 a) Tina Turner b) Culture Club c) Michael Jackson d) The Bangles
2 a) Ben Nevis b) 1922 c) Gordon Brown, Tony Blair, John Major, Margaret Thatcher d) Tudor rose

3 Springtime wordsearch

Find all the words relating to the warmer season in this wordsearch and you could win a £25 Morrisons voucher.

Daffodils	**Easter**	**Blossom**	**Cleaning**
Chicks	**Lambs**	**Chocolate**	**Bonnets**

C	A	L	E	T	R	I	M	T	S	E	R	E	A	T
D	H	A	A	P	I	O	O	T	A	A	G	E	N	A
A	I	O	T	M	S	T	E	D	H	S	O	I	M	E
F	L	T	C	S	B	N	E	F	P	T	S	E	I	L
F	I	O	O	O	N	S	O	O	I	E	E	D	E	V
O	H	L	O	O	L	B	B	R	N	R	N	E	S	A
D	B	H	B	D	E	A	N	N	S	T	I	E	T	E
I	A	T	H	O	S	E	T	E	S	P	U	M	D	Y
L	F	T	R	E	E	A	H	E	E	A	I	H	Y	S
S	N	D	S	N	D	D	O	C	S	T	H	C	P	U
C	L	E	A	N	I	N	G	H	S	E	Y	M	T	P
O	R	W	D	A	L	I	F	I	H	A	U	H	L	G
O	R	G	E	T	U	N	X	C	H	A	O	E	E	O
N	C	A	E	S	E	N	H	K	G	O	I	O	D	N
Y	N	S	E	T	O	H	R	S	H	Y	M	U	B	T

Please return the completed wordsearch along with your details to: Anita Dagger, Gallions Housing Association, Freepost SE6691, London, SE2 9BR or drop it into our reception by 8th May 2009. The winner will be selected at random.

Name: _____

Address: _____

Telephone: _____

Email: _____

Congratulations to Lisa Payne of Rowntree Path who was selected as the winner of our last wordsearch competition.

Changes for Team Gallions

Team Gallions, our environmental services team, has recently undergone a review to help enhance efficiency, improve customer service and plan for the future.

From April 2009 we will be increasing the availability of Team Gallions staff from Monday to Friday.

This will help us improve the service our residents receive and ensure that we can care for our neighbourhoods at the busiest times. The changes will mean that:

- During Saturdays, Sundays and summer bank holidays six staff will work from 8am to 1pm. (The service during winter bank holidays, including Christmas Day, will stay the same).
- Two staff will work each Sunday during the sports season (9am to 5pm) to cover sports attendance at Crossways Park and Birchmere Park when required.
- During Monday to Friday customer facing Team Gallions staff will now end their working day at 3.30pm. A one hour lunch break at the Gallions office will be replaced by a 30 minute break onsite.



We will continue to monitor our service and evaluate the impact of these alterations.

If you would like to find out more about Team Gallions or have feedback about these changes please contact Tom Broad on 0800 83 84 81.

A new board structure

In January 2009 Gallions Housing Association changed its board structure in response to new business and governance challenges. This latest structure also ensures that more of our residents are able to shape our services and help develop our standards.

We now have a Group Board that oversees the strategic direction of the organisation. The Group Board is made up of:

- Four independent members
- Two resident members
- The Chief Executive Officer

This is supported by a Neighbourhood Management Board and an Audit Committee. The Neighbourhood Management Board will oversee the Neighbourhood and Asset Management strategies agreed by the Group Board and monitor performance. The membership comprises of:

- Four resident members
- One independent member or co-optee from the Group Board
- Two local authority members
- The Director of Operations

For regulatory and good practice purposes the Audit Committee is separate to the boards. To find out more about our new governance structure contact the Thamesview Team on 0800 83 84 81 or email thamesview@gallionsha.co.uk.

At Gallions we celebrate the diversity of our neighbourhoods. We offer a comprehensive translation service to make communicating with us easy. If you would like this issue of Thamesview magazine translated into your own language please contact us. You can call 0800 83 84 81, email translations@gallionsha.co.uk or visit our office at Harrow Manorway, Thamesmead, London, SE2 9XH. We can translate documents into any language and have audio, large print and Braille options available.

ਗੈਲੀਅਨਜ਼ ਵਿਚ ਅਸੀਂ ਆਪਣੇ ਇਲਾਕਿਆਂ ਵਿਚਲੇ ਵਖਰੇਵਿਆਂ ਦੀ ਕਦਰ ਕਰਦੇ ਹਾਂ। ਸਾਡੇ ਨਾਲ ਗੱਲ ਬਾਤ ਕਰਨਾ ਸੌਖਾ ਬਣਾਉਣ ਲਈ ਅਸੀਂ ਤਰਜਮਾ ਕਰਨ ਦੀ ਮੁਫ਼ਤ ਸਹੂਲਤ ਦਿੰਦੇ ਹਾਂ। ਜੇ ਤੁਸੀਂ ਆਪਣੇ ਘਰ ਦੀ ਜ਼ਬਾਨ ਮਥਮੈਗਜ਼ੀਨ ਨੂੰ ਵੇਖਣ ਵਾਲੇ ਇਸ ਪਰਚੇ ਦਾ ਤਰਜਮਾ ਆਪਣੀ ਬੋਲੀ ਵਿਚ ਕਰਵਾਉਣਾ ਚਾਹੁੰਦੇ ਹੋ, ਤਾਂ ਕਿਰਪਾ ਕਰਕੇ ਸਾਡੇ ਨਾਲ ਸੰਪਰਕ ਕਰੋ। ਤੁਸੀਂ ਸਾਨੂੰ ਨੰਬਰ 0800 83 84 81 'ਤੇ ਫ਼ੋਨ ਕਰ ਸਕਦੇ ਹੋ, ਜਾਂ ਇਸ ਪਤੇ 'ਤੇ ਈਮੇਲ ਭੇਜ ਸਕਦੇ ਹੋ translations@gallionsha.co.uk ਜਾਂ ਅੱਗੇ ਦੀ ਪਤੇ 'ਤੇ ਸਾਡੇ ਦਫ਼ਤਰ ਵਿਚ ਗੇੜਾ ਮਾ ਸਕਦੇ ਹੋ . Harrow Manorway, Thamesmead, London, SE2 9XH. ਅਸੀਂ ਦਸਤਾਵੇਜ਼ਾਂ ਦਾ ਤਰਜਮਾ ਕਿਸੇ ਵੀ ਬੋਲੀ ਵਿਚ ਕਰ ਸਕਦੇ ਹਾਂ. ਅਤੇ ਦਸਤਾਵੇਜ਼ ਸੁਣਨ ਵਾਲੀ ਟੇਪ 'ਤੇ, ਵੱਡੇ ਅੱਖਰਾਂ ਵਿਚ ਅਤੇ ਬ੍ਰੇਲ ਵਿਚ ਵੀ ਦੇ ਸਕਦੇ ਹਾਂ।

Chúng tôi vui mừng vì sự đa dạng về dân cư ở Gallions. Chúng tôi cung cấp dịch vụ dịch thuật toàn diện để tạo điều kiện dễ dàng cho quí vị liên lạc với chúng tôi. Nếu quí vị muốn dịch số này của cuốn Tạp chí Thamesview sang ngôn ngữ của quí vị, hãy liên hệ với chúng tôi. Quí vị có thể gọi điện thoại theo số 0800 83 84 81, gửi thư điện tử theo địa chỉ translations@gallionsha.co.uk hoặc đến văn phòng của chúng tôi tại Harrow Manorway, Thamesmead, London, SE2 9XH. Chúng tôi có thể dịch các tài liệu sang bất kỳ ngôn ngữ nào và luôn sẵn có các lựa chọn khác như ghi âm, in khổ lớn và chữ nổi.

格蘭恩斯房屋協會 (Gallions) 頌揚我們鄰舍地區的多元化面貌。我們提供全面的翻譯服務，以便他們與我們進行溝通。如欲要求我們把本期的 Thamesview 雜誌翻譯成繁體中文 (廣東話)，請告訴我們。你可以致電 0800 83 84 81、發送電郵到 translations@gallionsha.co.uk，或親臨我們位於 Harrow Manorway, Thamesmead, London, SE2 9XH 的辦事處提出要求。我們可以將文件翻譯成任何語文，也備有語音、特大字體和凸字版本，以供選擇。

Punjabi ◯ **Vietnamese** ◯ **Chinese** ◯
(Please tick one)

Name

Address

Return to: Anita Dagger, Translation Requests, Gallions Housing Association Harrow Manor Way, London SE2 9XH.

Action on anti-social behaviour



Gallions takes reports of anti-social behaviour seriously and investigates complaints promptly and impartially. Anti-social behaviour is any unacceptable activity that can negatively affect the quality of community life, including:

- Nuisance neighbours
- Yobbish behaviour and intimidating groups taking over public spaces
- Vandalism and graffiti
- People dealing and buying drugs on the street
- People dumping rubbish and abandoned cars
- Begging and anti-social drinking
- The misuse of fireworks
- Illegal use of motor cycles

When you tell us about an incident of anti-social behaviour we will:

- Keep your identity confidential
- Contact you within 3 days to discuss the complaint, or within 24 hours if the complaint involves racial harassment or domestic violence
- Contact the person you have reported to us within 5 days to discuss the complaint with them
- Provide you with written confirmation of the action being taken within 10 working days

If it is relevant and you agree, we may refer your case to a mediation service to try and resolve the issues. If the problem persists we may carry out further investigation and ask you to complete diary sheets when each incident occurs. Once the investigation has been completed and the complaints verified, we will send a final warning letter to the person responsible for the anti-social behaviour telling them that their behaviour must stop and what action we will take if it continues.

If the anti-social behaviour continues we may use a range of legal and non-legal methods to prevent the anti-social behaviour. These could include one or more of the following:

- Advice
- Letters and visits
- Mediation
- The involvement of other agencies
- Acceptable Behaviour Contracts
- Anti-social Behaviour Orders
- Injunctions
- Possession action

Taking legal action against the person responsible for the anti-social behaviour can take some time and it is not always successful. We will continue to support you throughout this process by keeping you up to date with the progress of the case, discussing other measures that we could put in place to ensure you feel safe, arranging support from other agencies and organising for regular visits from our Neighbourhood Warden team.

In January and February of this year we have:

- Responded to 116 anti-social behaviour reports
- Evicted one family due to ongoing anti-social behaviour
- Obtained a Court Injunction in response to ongoing anti-social behaviour
- Entered into 2 Acceptable Behaviour Agreements with young people who had been involved in anti-social behaviour.

In February 87% of those who made reports to us said they were happy with the outcome and 100% told us they found their Housing Officer helpful, courteous, sensitive, responsive and knowledgeable.

Please get in touch if you have an issue in your neighbourhood. You can report anti-social behaviour in a number of different ways:

- Call us on 0800 83 84 81 or 0208 320 3441
- Visit our website at www.gallionsha.co.uk
- Talk to your Housing Officer, a Neighbourhood Warden or our reception team
- Write to us at Gallions Housing Association, Harrow Manor Way, London, SE2 9XH

Latest news for Leaseholders

This leaseholder special is all about managing your money. Get in touch if you need advice or support.

Help with debt

We want to help you if you are struggling with debts and bills so we have put together some top tips below:

- Gallions' in-house Welfare Benefits Advisor, Derek Stainsby, helps residents understand and access benefits. If you are struggling with debt he may be able to help you. Call us on 0800 83 84 81 or pop into our reception to make an appointment.
- Ask the Leasehold Team for a self-help money advice pack if you would like to deal with your creditors at your own pace.
- Contact National Debtline on 0808 808 4000 or visit the Citizens Advice Bureau website at www.citizensadvice.org.uk for details of your nearest centre. You will receive free, confidential and independent debt advice. If you don't have internet access call the Thamesview Team on 0800 83 84 81 and we will find the contact information you need.
- Please be aware of companies advertising that they can help with debt. Some of them will charge a hefty fee - on average £1500 - for their services and will only deal with your non-secure debts. They will not help with your rent, mortgage or secure loans.

Buying back your home

A number of our shared owners and leaseholders have contacted us recently about Gallions buying back their properties. We do sometimes buy back properties but each year our requirements change. Please write to the Development Team, Gallions Housing Association, Harrow Manor Way, London, SE2 9XH if you want to find out if we will buy back your home.

Negative equity

Some of our shared owners are in a difficult position at the moment as their properties are now worth less than they paid for them 4 years ago and they may owe their mortgage lender more than the share of the property is worth. This is called negative equity. If you need to sell your property, you must speak to your lender first as they have to agree to a sale. If you don't speak to them and they repossess and sell your property at auction, it may sell for less and you could owe them more money. Please contact us on 0800 83 84 81 if you are struggling with mortgage and rent payments.

Sub-letting – shared owners

A number of shared owners have asked us about sub-letting their properties. The shared ownership lease does not allow this. There are a couple of exceptional circumstances where we would agree to a short period of sub-letting subject to strict criteria, for example if you are a key worker and are posted abroad as part of your contract; or if you are overcrowded and unable to sell in the current market. It is unlikely that an agreement to sub-let would be given in any other circumstances.

Staircasing – buying more shares or selling your home

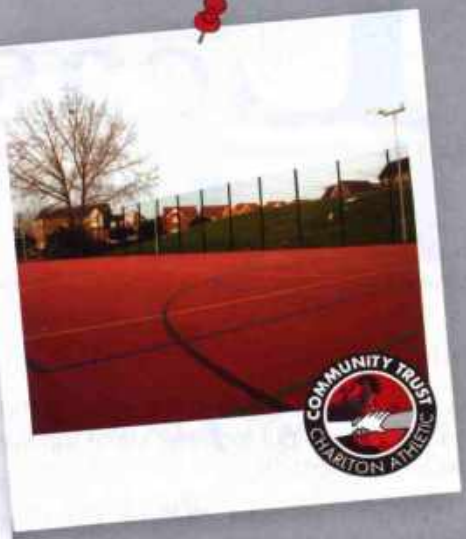
If you are buying or selling, it is really important to use a solicitor who understands leases. The leasehold team have a list of solicitors and financial advisers who will be able to help you through the legal and financial process, just contact us on 0800 83 84 81 to find out more.

Leasehold Forums in 2009

We hold regular leasehold forums so that you can tell us your views and let us know about any suggestions or issues you have. All meetings are held at Gallions' offices in Harrow Manor Way. The next meetings will take place on:

- 25 June at 7 pm
- 22 September at 7pm
- 16 December at 2 pm

Notice Board



Sports pitch for hire

If you would like to get active this spring there is a great new 7 a-side multi-use games area available for hire at Linton Mead in Thamesmead. The pitch has a cushioned concrete surface, it is fully flood-lit and there are changing rooms with shower facilities and disabled access. The pitch is open every day and costs range from £15-£20 per hour for hire. Contact Kane Rice at Charlton Athletic Community Trust on 07515 412352 to find out more.



Fishing club is back

Following the success of the club last year, the Neighbourhood Wardens will be providing free fishing activities again in 2009 at Gallions Nature Centre, Bentham Road, Thamesmead. The first session will be on Wednesday 6th May 2009 from 5pm until 7pm and the club will be running until September 2009. All activities are free and you can come along for a taster session or all season! Beginners are very welcome and our expert fishing coaches will be on hand to instruct and guide you. All equipment and bait is supplied. Chat to a Neighbourhood Warden on patrol or call 0800 83 84 81 to find out more.

Free money advice magazine

Look out for the new Quids In magazine available to take away from our reception area. It is jam-packed with hints and tips o managing a budget, overcoming debt and the real cost of pre-payment meters. Martin Lewis, th Money Expert, is featured in this edition. Be sure to come in and pick up your free copy - they won be around for long! Contact us or 0800 83 84 81 if you need help managing your money.



Help with recycling in Bexley

If you live in the London Borough of Bexley you can get free advice about recycling and protecting the environment. There are two Recycling Wardens in Thamesmead dedicated to helping residents go green and reduce the amount of waste that goes to landfill.

The Recycling Wardens will help you recycle as much as possible by supplying recycling facilities for your property, be it a flat, a house, community centre or religious centre. It's completely free take part just contact Bexley Council on 0208 303 7777 (option 1) or email recyclingwardens@bexley.gov.uk.

CCTV is a hit!

The Neighbourhood Wardens are now responsible for monitoring all CCTV in our neighbourhoods and they have had some excellent results because of this technology. The Wardens have recently been able to provide important evidence to police, which has helped them to identify those responsible for criminal activities and has resulted in convictions and the signing of Acceptable Behaviour Agreements.

The Wardens also use covert CCTV where necessary to identify anti-social behaviour in places where there are no static cameras. Gallions continues to invest in CCTV and we never use dummy cameras. We need residents to report any problems to us so we can act - please contact the Neighbourhood Wardens on 0800 83 84 81 if you have any issues in your area.

Painting of Abbey Road Bridge

Our Neighbourhood Projects Team has been working closely with the London Probation Service, who has recently completed painting at the Abbey Road Footbridge. This work adds to the colourful mural that was created by young people in Thamesmead in Spring 2008 and will help improve the look and feel of what was once a heavily graffitied walkway. Contact the Neighbourhood Projects team on 0800 83 84 81 if you are interested in improving our community spaces.

Careers at Gallions

Details of our current employment opportunities are publicised on our website and at our reception desk. Please get in touch on 0800 83 84 81 if you are interested in a career with us.

Complaints and contacts

Gallions aims to provide a first class service to all its residents. However, if you are unhappy with the service you have received there is a policy in place to help you make a complaint. A guide is available on our website.

Complaints@gallionsha.co.uk

www.gallionsha.co.uk

0800 83 84 81

Thamesview publication details

Thamesview is published by Gallions Housing Association, Harrow Manor Way, London, SE2 9XH and is free to Gallions' residents and anyone else who wishes to obtain a copy.

RENT A HOMEBUY AVAILABLE

SPOT THE HOMEOWNER



Who received free financial advice to secure a mortgage and took advantage of Gallions first time buyers bundle?*

Actually, any one of them could be a homeowner. With a Gallions part buy, part rent shared ownership scheme, you could own a share in a 1 or 2 bedroom property. All you need is a salary of £21,000 and savings from £5,000 and you could take advantage of Gallions unique goody bundle. You can even move in with a friend if you earn over £25,000 together. Arrange a viewing today.

*Offer only applies to Ringside Court and Phoenix Point.

Bundle

GET 6 MONTHS' RENT BREAK, ALONG WITH TWO OF THE FOLLOWING:

- **£500** furniture package
- A **fridge-freezer** or **dishwasher**
- **£500** towards legal fees

Visit **www.creatinghomeowners.co.uk**, call **0800 7314587**, or email **homes@gallionsha.co.uk** for more information.

Gallions Housing Association

Have fun & win!

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Answers:
1. a) Frogs legs b) Cornwall.
2. Dear, dean, lean, loan, moa

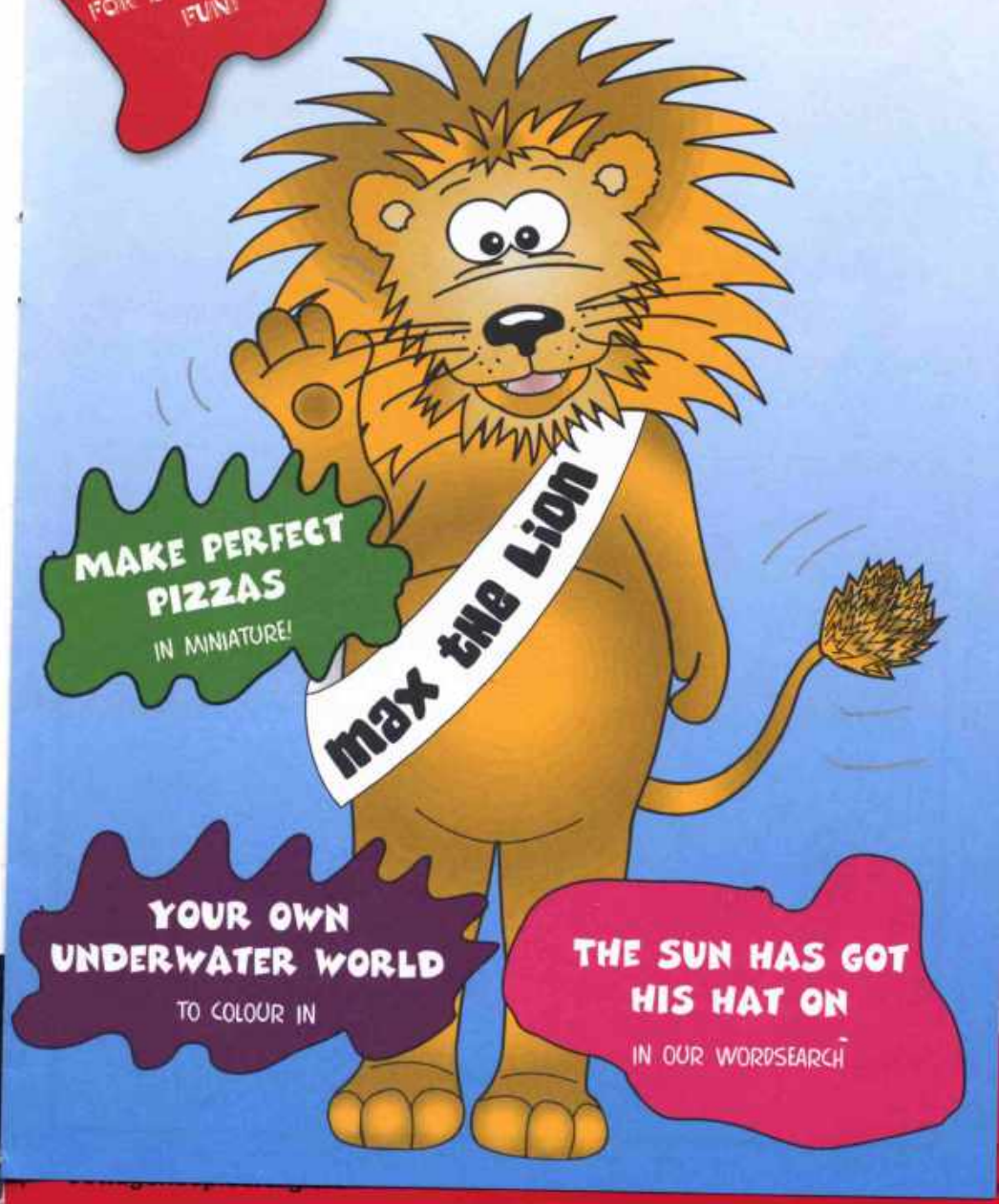
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LOOK INSIDE FOR EVEN MORE FUN!

kidsview

gallionsha.co.uk | July 2009



Hospice Lottery first draw 31 July

The first draw for the newly established Lottery in support of the Greenwich & Bexley Cottage Hospice will take place on this day. This lottery will help to raise funds to support the very special work of the Hospice.

Need more details? To sign up as a player call Greenwich and Bexley Cottage Hospice on 020 8312 2244 or visit www.cottagehospice.org.uk

2009

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**Need more details? Visit www.royal
call 0207 298 2079.**

Bank Holiday Mon
31 August

Enjoy the last bank holiday of the sum



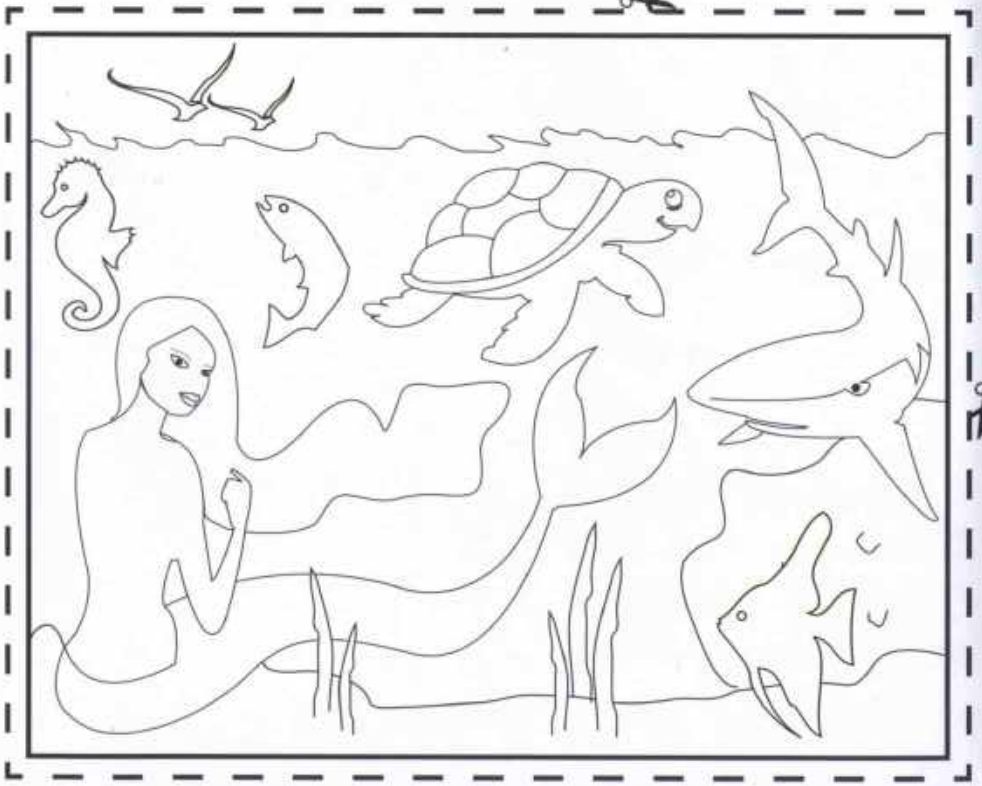
HI!

WELCOME BACK TO KIDSVIEW! I HOPE YOU HAVE FUN MAKING TASTY PIZZAS, UNSCRAMBLING THE MUSICAL WORDS AND DOING THE SUMMERTIME WORDSEARCH.

STAY IN CONTACT BY EMAILING ME AT MAXTHELION@GALLIONSHA.CO.UK

YOUR VERY OWN UNDERWATER WORLD!

COLOUR IN AND CUT OUT THIS FANTASTIC UNDERWATER SCENE. WITH FISH, TURTLES AND A MERMAID YOU CAN MAKE THIS PICTURE REALLY BRIGHT!

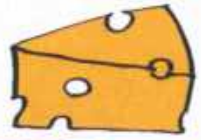


H C I L
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Name:

DELICIOUS MINI PIZZAS

WHY NOT TRY MAKING ONE OF THESE SUPER TASTY PIZZAS? PERFECT AS A SUMMERTIME SNACK.



YOU WILL NEED:

- 1 BAGEL, CUT IN HALF
- TOMATO KETCHUP
- SHREDDED MOZZARELLA CHEESE
- 2 TOPPINGS FROM THE FOLLOWING: SWEETCORN, TOMATO CHUNKS, RED OR GREEN PEPPER SLICES, ONIONS, HAM, CHICKEN





INSTRUCTIONS:

- ASK AN ADULT TO PUT THE OVEN ON A LOW HEAT
- SPREAD TOMATO KETCHUP ON EACH BAGEL HALF
- SPRINKLE THE SHREDDED CHEESE ALL OVER THE BAGEL HALVES
- ADD YOUR FAVOURITE 2 TOPPINGS
- WITH HELP FROM AN ADULT, BAKE IN THE OVEN ON A LOW HEAT FOR 5 TO 8 MINUTES OR UNTIL THE CHEESE BUBBLES
- COOL FOR A MINUTE AND THEN EAT!



MUSICAL WORDS

ALL THESE WORDS ABOUT MUSIC ARE MIXED UP – CAN YOU UNSCRAMBLE THEM?

1. AIR TUG .....
2. RESIGN .....
3. R MUD .....
4. BAD N .....



ANSWERS
MUSICAL WORDS – 1) GUITAR 2) SINGER 3) DRUM 4) BAND

Gallions Housing Association

Hospice Lottery first draw

wildlife spotting and f

Need more details?

COOL COMPETITION!

Max the Lion is really looking forward to the summer holidays! Can you find all the summertime words in this wordsearch?

If you find all the words send your completed wordsearch and the entry form to us by 31st July 2009 for the chance to win a fantastic summer activity pack!

Beach Sports Fun Lolly Sunny

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N	O	N	A	T	W	A	N	H	N	A
L	C	O	U	F	I	S	A	A	Y	C

Please return your completed form to Anita Dagger, Gallions Housing Association, Freepost SE6891, London, SE2 9BR or drop your entry into our reception by 31st July 2009. The winner will be selected at random.

Name: _____

Name of parent or guardian: _____

Address: _____

_____ Telephone: _____

Congratulations to ROCCO ALI BARRETT OF FLOATHAVEN CLOSE who was selected as the winner of our last competition!

The winner will be selected at random.

Name: _____

Address: _____

Telephone: _____

Email: _____

Congratulations to Miss Diep of Maran Way who was selected as the winner of our last wordsearch competition.